

STEM4U — FTC Event-Day Checklist & Pit Packing List

Show up ready — nothing forgotten · BIOBUZZ 2026-27

Pack the night before

Robot & power - ☐ Robot (on a cart) + any attachments - ☐ **All batteries fully charged** + at least one spare + charger - ☐ Driver Station device (charged) + gamepads + USB cables

Documents - ☐ **Engineering Portfolio** (printed copies for judges) + engineering notebook - ☐ **Consent/registration** confirmed for every participant - ☐ This checklist + the scoring reference + robot rules cheat sheet

Tools & spares - ☐ Hex/Allen keys, screwdrivers, wrenches, pliers, wire cutters/strippers - ☐ Zip ties, electrical + gaffer tape, spare screws/nuts, extra wires/connectors - ☐ Spare motor, servo, and any part that's failed before - ☐ Multimeter, sharpie, notepad

People & comfort - ☐ Water + snacks, team spirit (shirts/signs), a small first-aid kit - ☐ Roster of who's coming; adult supervisor(s) confirmed

When you arrive — set up the pit

- ☐ Find your pit, set up the cart and tools, plug in the charger
- ☐ **Charge the rotation** — always have the next battery charging
- ☐ Get the event schedule; note **inspection**, **practice**, **match**, and **judging** times
- ☐ Do a quick power-on + drive test

Inspection

- ☐ Run the **Pre-Inspection Checklist** before you get in line (size, wiring, battery, team number)
- ☐ Bring the robot powered-off, on the cart, with a charged battery
- ☐ Fix any flagged item and re-inspect — don't skip it

Match flow (every match)

- ☐ Grab a **freshly charged battery**; confirm it's seated and the switch is on
- ☐ Load the correct autonomous OpMode; confirm Driver Station connects
- ☐ Drive team to the field on time; know your **alliance color** and starting spot
- ☐ After the match: back to the pit, **swap the battery to charge**, quick inspect for damage, note what to fix

Judging (when judges visit)

- ☐ Run the **Judging Prep Pack** roles — opener, robot lead, team/outreach lead, software lead

- ☐ Portfolio out and ready; everyone knows their one thing to speak to

Between matches — the pit crew loop

Charge → inspect for damage → make the one highest-priority fix → log it in the notebook → be ready 2 matches early.

End of day

- ☐ Pack all tools/spares (do a headcount of expensive items)
- ☐ Put batteries on to charge for the next day (if multi-day)
- ☐ Debrief: what worked, what broke, what to fix before next event
- ☐ Thank volunteers and other teams — **Gracious Professionalism**

The one rule that saves events: *always have the next battery charging. A dead battery loses more matches than a bad robot.*